

The Social Radars

Founder Mode: Chris Best, Founder & CEO of Substack

Released September 4, 2025

Jessica: I'm Jessica Livingston, and Carolynn and I are the Social Radars. I'm just kidding. You're supposed to laugh because that's how the intro usually goes. It's a recording of me. But, of course, we are here live today in front of an audience of Y Combinator founders, alumni who are here for the Y Combinator Founder Mode Retreat.

[\(00:00:00\)](#)

And I'm delighted to have an audience for the first time. Right, Carolynn? That's excellent. We're very excited. Yeah.

Yay. And we are here today with Chris Best, the Founder and CEO of Substack. And I am so excited to talk to you today, Chris, because for having me. I don't know much about Substack because you went through Y Combinator in winter eighteen

Chris: Yes.

[\(00:00:48\)](#)

Jessica: After I had moved to England. So I can't wait to hear your story. What I'd like you to do, if you don't mind, is telling the audience what Substack is for anyone who doesn't know.

[\(00:00:49\)](#)

Chris: Oh god. This is my this is the one question. It's so hard to answer. Yeah. Substack is a is a media network.

[\(00:01:01\)](#)

It's a publishing platform for independent creators, and increasingly, it's a place you can go and find all the smartest and best independent voices in the world.

Jessica: Everyone seems to be using it, and there's so many interesting things found on it. But tell us how you got started.

[\(00:01:15\)](#)

Chris: So I've always been an avid reader, not an elevated reader, but an avid reader and consumer of media. And I've always believed that what you read matters. It's not just a way that you spend some fraction of your life and attention, although, you know, even if the media you consume was just the time you spent, that's important enough. But, you know, the media you consume and especially what you read shapes how you think, shapes how you see the world, and changes who you to be who you become. It's like your training data.

[\(00:01:22\)](#)

And so great writing is this valuable thing. And after I left, my first startup where I was a technical cofounder, I was taking some a sit up sabbatical. I was taking time off. I was seeing my friends and family and reading books and learning to fly airplanes and all the things you don't have time to do if you're running a startup. And so, naturally, I was like, I should write.

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How hard how hard could it be? I know how to type. Like, I have thoughts that I I'm very impressed with. And I started writing what I thought was gonna be an essay or a blog post sort of outlining my frustrations with the media economy on the Internet. Basically, this screed that says, wah.

You know, the Internet came along and smashed all of the business models for culture, And these massive Internet scale networks that have taken its place are phenomenal businesses, but they're driving us fucking crazy. Wah goes this essay. And I wrote it, and I sent it to my friend Hamish, who's in the audience somewhere. He's my cofounder now, who's actually a writer. He'd been a journalist.

He'd written books. He'd was lead writer at Tesla for a while. And I was like, what do you think? And he let me down very gently. You know?

He said, okay. It's 2017, Chris. And your thesis is maybe newspapers are in trouble, and maybe Facebook is not an unalloyed good. This is not the quite the original, you know, brilliant thought. Like, the we know this.

This is known. Yeah. This is not gonna come as a shock or as a as a novel insight to anyone. But the more interesting question, like, here's how you could improve this essay. Add a section that says, so what do you do about it?

Like, how could this be different? Given that this techno this these technological shifts have happened, and let's assume that it's played out in exactly the way you're complaining about. Where do we go forward from here? And we started arguing about that, and that argument turned into not a finished essay that was any good, but into a company that we built.

Jessica: [\(00:03:48\)](#) What were the first things that you did? You said, okay. That makes sense. What could we do? Then what did you do?

Chris: [\(00:03:53\)](#) So this is this is, this is our story of what we did, not what I would necessarily recommend that anybody do. But the first thing that we did was write a manifesto. Oh

Jessica: [\(00:04:02\)](#) My gosh. Okay.

Chris: [\(00:04:04\)](#) And so Hamish started writing the manifesto. We worked on it together, and I started writing the little blogging software that was gonna host this manifesto. Because we're not gonna post our founding manifesto on somebody else's software. That would be ridiculous.

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Jessica: And so a programmer by trade.

[\(00:04:16\)](#)

Chris: I'm a I'm a programmer. I'm a sort of a you know, I was a technical cofounder of my last company. We sort of built the things. And so we did that. We wrote this manifesto, and I've stood up this very simple blogging platform, and we published it.

[\(00:04:18\)](#)

And somebody that, Hamish knew from, his journalism career read this manifesto and said, hey. I, you know, I think I need this. Like, this is the thing that we you know, I've been I've been writing this email newsletter, and I could I've been wanting to go paid like Ben Thompson does. And but I can't kind of be you know, I can't be bothered to figure out how to connect all the pieces because we'd sort of at this point, our the idea for Substack was both kind of this sweeping, very grandiose idea that I've been trying to put down in this essay of, like, a new economic engine for culture that creates a new incentive structure that has better emergent outcomes and blah.

Jessica: That was in your manifesto?

[\(00:05:08\)](#)

Chris: It was not very well.

[\(00:05:10\)](#)

Jessica: Okay.

[\(00:05:11\)](#)

Chris: But there was the energy for all of that was there.

[\(00:05:12\)](#)

Jessica: Did you call it manifesto?

[\(00:05:14\)](#)

Chris: We referred to it as a manifesto among ourselves. Right. We had the grace not to put manifesto in the title on Absolutely. And, but we so we had this we had this very grandiose idea, but we also had this very, like, simple kernel to begin with. We're like, okay.

[\(00:05:16\)](#)

The smallest possible instantiation of this harebrained scheme is like a service that makes it dead easy to make a paid email newsletter. Because that is the it is the smallest instantiation. People are gonna be able to use the Internet to go independent in a new way. There's a different business model. There's already people doing this.

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Their incentive structure is different and better. They want to make things that cause people to fall in love with the work they're doing and want to retain and give them value rather than just get as much attention as possible. And that's where we started. We wrote this manifesto. We got our first customer.

We applied to YC. We had really good timing.

Jessica: [\(00:06:08\)](#) Can I ask a quick question about Hamish? Because I believe he was a writer at Panda Daily. Might he have been creating this for his own use? Like, did he wanna leave and be an independent journalist?

Chris: [\(00:06:21\)](#) You'd have to ask him that. I certainly think he wanted he was creating something that he himself wanted. Like, he knew he's a writer. He lived this thing. He'd gone and written a book and had the heartache of doing that.

He'd been trying to craft that, you know, a career as a professional writer and journalist. And so he was the class of person that was gonna be the initial customer for this. I don't know whether he planned to quit and go start his own at some point. He hasn't yet, and he hasn't if he still has plans, he hasn't told me. But

Jessica: [\(00:06:51\)](#) Who was your first user?

Chris: [\(00:06:52\)](#) So our first real user was this guy named Bill Bishop who wrote a newsletter called cynicism. It's a it's a terrible pun. And it's a newsletter about China for, like, a international business and government audience. And, he'd like he wanted to go paid with it. It was, like, widely respected, and we just he's like, yeah.

Okay. If you wanna build a thing that lets me charge for this, you can build it. And so we applied to YC with this idea. We put on the application form. You know, we're making \$0 in revenue.

And then between the interview or the application, the interview, we launched this first customer, Bill. And I think he made, like, a \$100 his first day. Really? And I was sitting there on this, like, hacked together, like, you know, light stripe wrapper that I'd written. And I was like, is this good?

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I think this might be good. And so we show up for the YC interview, and they say, well, it's just here you make \$0. And I said, ah, I have a I have an update on that. Like, here's what's happened. And very memorably, I think it was maybe Jared who told me, oh, you got the you got one customer.

If you just get, like, two or three more like that, you're gonna be golden. Like, this is gonna be you know, you're sailing.

Jessica: [\(00:08:03\)](#) You remember this, Carolyn? Because you were in the I was in the interview, and Jared and Adora were also in it. And, I don't actually remember this. Okay. But I went and read I mean, I went and looked at it, we were all pretty excited about you guys.

So it must have been, like, super positive that you had

Chris: [\(00:08:17\)](#) Glad to hear it.

Jessica: [\(00:08:18\)](#) These updates. How did this writer make a \$100?

Chris: [\(00:08:21\)](#) Well, because he'd been doing it for years. So he was like there was probably, like, five people on Earth who were, like, the perfect early customer for this thing that just already needed it so much. And so he was like had all these users who had wanted to pay him. So it wasn't he was starting. It wasn't he was growing.

He was like he literally just sent them an email being like, this cost money now, and they're like, here's the money.

Jessica: [\(00:08:42\)](#) Wow. Wow. And how did you get him?

Chris: [\(00:08:45\)](#) Hamish knew him. And we've Okay. We flew down to DC and, like, talked to him and convinced him and brought him on. And, of course, they're like, oh, you just gotta get two or three more like this. He was our biggest customer for years.

We did not taste success like that again for many years. And I sometimes joke, you know, how they say that, professional gamblers often start their career with a winning streak? And, of course, that's just selection bias where people who start their career with a losing streak don't become professional gamblers. I kinda feel like Substack's like that a little bit. Like, we had that early win.

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We were like, oh, this is gonna be so easy. Like, off we go. And it did not turn out to be that easy, but that initial push gave us a lot of courage to go for a long time.

Jessica: [\(00:09:24\)](#) So you apply to YC. You get accepted. Do you remember anything from that winter that was pivotal for Substack's growth and success?

Chris: [\(00:09:34\)](#) There is There is one thing I remember where every week we would meet with Jared, and he would say, have you launched it yet? Sounds familiar. Say, well, no. But we have good reasons why we you know? Because at the time, if you wanted to make a new Substack, I had to input it into the database.

Like, I was like, yeah. Talk to me, and I'll launch for you. And he's like, have you launched it yet? And I would say, oh, no. But here's why first we have to blah.

And, eventually, he just completely shamed me into it. He's like, you guys are being complete idiots here. Like, launch your goddamn service. Wow. That was important.

Had you not done that? Chair. Yeah. He was I mean, he said it. He did the gentle thing where he causes you to realize yourself how much of an idiot you're being.

And then we did. And, like, if we hadn't launched it, it wouldn't have worked. I'll tell you that much.

Jessica: [\(00:10:21\)](#) Did you launch that during the three months?

Chris: [\(00:10:23\)](#) Yes.

Jessica: [\(00:10:24\)](#) Okay. And then did you do okay at demo day? Were people that were interested

Chris: [\(00:10:29\)](#) In Yeah. There was people that were interested. I kinda feel like we're maybe, like, a you know, somewhere in, like, the third quartile. Maybe we're the median company in our batch at demo day. It's sort of my emotional recollection of it.

I have no data on that. So we were like, it was good. We raised around. It was a good thing. We had you know, there was believers, but we were not one of, like, the hot companies.

Maybe we're still not. There's still companies from that batch that are crushing it.

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Jessica: [\(00:10:55\)](#) Then tell us about, like, sort of the next biggest thing that happened in your growth because you're huge now.

Chris: [\(00:11:02\)](#) Yeah. I mean, there's just been a there's been a series of eras. Right? So, I mean, leading up to demo day, I remember we didn't have a group subscription feature, but there was one customer that was selling a lot of group subscriptions. So we just manually went and sold a bunch of group subscriptions to these, like, bankruptcy firms in order to make our, like, demo day numbers.

That was pretty fun. And then we were just grinding for a while and trying to, like, get people, you know, get people to join, you know, convince early customers to start and become sort of lighthouses and then sort of tip them over and sell them on the religion of this thing that we were doing. We ended up getting preempted in our series a kind of unexpectedly because we, we tried to recruit Andrew Chan to write for Substack because he'd been at Uber. He had this really good blog, and we kept trying to recruit him to come work at Substack. And, eventually, he joined and called us up and was like, okay.

I'm not gonna I'm not bringing my blog over, but, like, do you wanna come talk to us? And we're like, no. Leave us alone. We're busy. We don't talk to investors.

He's like, oh, come. Have dinner with Mark. Come do the thing. And so we ended up, like, getting kind of, like, preempted in our series a and having a whole thing there. But, yeah, we grew the thing for there's lots of lots of twists and turns.

Jessica: [\(00:12:16\)](#) We have a little bit less time than usual. So what I would love to get to, and I know Carolyn's interested too, we want to ask you about when you launch sort of a Twitter competitor. But since this is the Founder Mode conference, we wanna talk a little bit about Founder Mode because there is a, you know, clear definition for it. It's things you can do as a founder CEO that a hired manager wouldn't or couldn't do, but we're not really sure what that means in practice. So we're we're kind of collecting data here today that that we're hoping to share with the world.

So I know I think these two stories converge, like examples of you being in founder mode and some drama with Elon Musk converge. So that could be a very time efficient thing to do, don't you think?

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Chris:

[\(00:13:06\)](#)

Yeah. Well okay. So here would be my answer to the Founder Mode thing, which is I think one thing we've been able to do is have kind of a long term principled vision for why we're making the thing we're doing and what the actual center of the idea is and why it ought to win and to be kind of, like, very sort of long term greedy about that. And then to take seriously the consequences of what that theory about the world actually means, which I think is not every startup is like this. Like, I think a lot of people pivot and discover things, and we've definitely we're learning stuff all the time.

But we started the company with this very grandiose idea and manifesto and all this stuff. And so we sort of knew that we wanted to build this new you know? At every stage, the product has been this there's a handle. You have to give people a handle to it of how to understand it. But the thing that we've always felt that we were building is this new economic engine for culture.

And we wanted to be able to, like, create a platform that could spark a renaissance, basically. And we're not supposed to be the heroes of that thing. It's supposed to be the people who are the writers, the creators, the people making and living in the culture. That's the exciting part. And so we're like, we had this idea.

Like, we have to make this economic engine, and the system and the social contract we make for it has to be better, and that's what pulls people in. And then it has to actually work. It has to actually compete and be a good product that people willingly adopt because it's great. And so we were along the way, we knew we had to do those things, and we would discover pieces that we were missing. And so one big piece at the start, we were this tool.

Right? You could you could host a blog. You could run an email newsletter. You could charge subscriptions. Once people found you, they could fall in love with you and pay for you, and that was great, and everything worked.

But the flaw in that system was where did they find you?

Jessica:

[\(00:14:52\)](#)

Yeah. Yeah.

Chris:

[\(00:14:53\)](#)

And the

Jessica:

[\(00:14:54\)](#)

Place they find you?

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Chris: On every other social network. They found you on Twitter. They found you on Facebook. They found you on LinkedIn. It's increasingly now.

[\(00:14:55\)](#)

All these places. And so that meant two things. That meant that our little beautiful city we were trying to build was downstream of the toxic sludge incentive factory of everywhere else. Because if you wanted to be great on Substack, you had to first be good at Twitter, or you

Jessica: Had to

[\(00:15:18\)](#)

Chris: First be good at Facebook. Yeah. It also meant that if Mark had a fit of pique inside of no more politics for a while, and you're a political writer on Substack that got all your traffic from Facebook, it's problem. Or as it turned out, if Elon buys Twitter and decides maybe I wanna buy Substack, and maybe if I can't, I'm gonna kill those guys, it creates a real problem.

[\(00:15:18\)](#)

Jessica: That sounds like an interesting story.

[\(00:15:41\)](#)

Chris: So Are you

[\(00:15:44\)](#)

Jessica: Open to sharing?

[\(00:15:45\)](#)

Chris: Yeah. So when we realized this, we started and this is maybe the Founder Mode part, is we started working on this. We had this cool business that was, like, this two sided marketplace that was growing. And at the time, it was, like we went through a period that was, like, super hot and flush market and people throwing money at us. But we knew that if we didn't build this network in the long run like, that was gonna be a very hard thing to do.

[\(00:15:47\)](#)

But in the long run, if we didn't do it, it wasn't gonna become the real thing. So we started investing in stuff that I think was not something that you would do if you were just trying to, like, maximize even the next, like, couple year value of the business. You wouldn't say, like, we have to go and build a mobile app. Right? That was something that's, like it's it's obviously very hard to do.

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It's, you know, it's you we had a we had a theory we thought was convincing for why we needed it in the long run, but it's just like it was a hard thing to believe in. A lot of people we told about it didn't think it was a good idea. I think PG might still think it was a bad idea. He's told me a few times. We'll find one of us will be right in the end.

So we built this mobile app. We built this short form feed. We realized, hey. This is just what's what like, this is we need the thing that is, like, fun to come to and pay attention to. Yes.

We wanna have this better system that support like, makes good use of your attention, but you don't have you can't be have to be a monk to use Substack. So we built this short form feed. We built this mobile app, and, we were about to launch it. And at the time, I think I'm trying to remember all the ins and outs of this, but Elon had bought Twitter. I think he was already, like, getting sick of running it and was, like, looking for a side it's, like, something to do.

And, you know, he had this very strong stance on free speech, freedom of the press. We had also have we had, like, have did had had and still had, like, a similar view that, you know, free press is essential to a free society. So he I mean, he called me up. He's like, hey. You wanna come meet?

And I was like, yeah. Okay. I'll do that. And I went I went and met him at the old Twitter HQ at, like, midnight

Jessica: Or something. Way. Of course.
[\(00:17:55\)](#)

Chris: At midnight. Yeah. You know, very dramatic hour. Talk to him. He's a fascinating guy.
[\(00:17:57\)](#)

Anyway, the long and short of it was he's like, you know, would you consider, you know, joining forces? Like, you know, let me buy Substack. Come run this Twitter thing, and, you know, that'd be cool. And I said, k. Let me think about it.

Jessica: Did he talk numbers?
[\(00:18:19\)](#)

Chris: No. No. I was like
[\(00:18:20\)](#)

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Jessica: Just concept the concept.
[\(00:18:21\)](#)

Chris: Conceptually. And at this was, like, weeks before we were like, not even weeks, days before we were gonna launch this, you know, thing that looks a lot like a Twitter competitor.

Jessica: Yeah. Oh my god.
[\(00:18:35\)](#)

Chris: And so when we went to launch it, like, as I was still in this little, you know, gap, I just I just let him know. I was like, hey. Just so you know, we're launching this thing. We've been planning it for a while. It's like, you know, this is just like a part of our long term strategy.

We're not trying to be a competitor and fight, and we're very aligned in a lot of, like, the things you're you know, a lot of the principles of things. And he was like, don't watch it. And I was like, no. Like

Jessica: This is after the meeting Yeah. Or during the meeting?
[\(00:19:08\)](#)

Chris: This is after.
[\(00:19:11\)](#)

Jessica: Okay. Okay.
[\(00:19:12\)](#)

Chris: So you
[\(00:19:14\)](#)

Jessica: Haven't told him no yet. You just gave him a heads up about the mobile.
[\(00:19:14\)](#)

Chris: Gave him a heads up, and we launched it. I'm not gonna not launch it. Yeah. And he was very unhappy.

Jessica: How did he express his unhappiness?
[\(00:19:27\)](#)

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Chris: [\(00:19:31\)](#) Well, you might remember this. There was, like, there was a week where the you couldn't say the word Substack on Twitter. So if you said the word Substack, your tweet would just nobody would see it. And so people started treating us like Voldemort. They would be like, the platform that cannot be named is where my article is.

And he but not only that. So you couldn't you couldn't say the word Substack. You couldn't search for the word Substack. And I think to this day, I think only us in the New York Times got this treatment, where if you did somehow accidentally find a link to a Substack article and clicked it, it would redirect there, but it would take five seconds.

Jessica: [\(00:20:09\)](#) Oh, he punished you with slowness.

Chris: [\(00:20:12\)](#) That's a that's a very serious thing. Did your legs take five seconds? Yeah. Five seconds is an eternity. Yeah.

And he I think he, like, he made some accus he sent me mean texts and got very angry, and I think he took it as a no.

Jessica: [\(00:20:26\)](#) I was just gonna say, like, was he, like, deals off? Like, consider it over?

Chris: [\(00:20:32\)](#) In stronger terms.

Jessica: [\(00:20:33\)](#) In strong oh, oh, okay. Wow. So you weren't intimidated?

Chris: [\(00:20:42\)](#) I wouldn't go that far. Okay. I mean, I drive a Tesla. I had moments where I was like, will he kill me?

Jessica: [\(00:20:54\)](#) That's a weird feeling now.

Chris: [\(00:20:56\)](#) You would. I still drive it, so I'm not that that concerned, I guess.

Jessica: [\(00:20:59\)](#) What year was this?

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Chris: [\(00:21:00\)](#) Somebody who remembers years told me. Was this 2022? Says yes.

Jessica: [\(00:21:05\)](#) Okay. Oh, 2022. Okay. So how much traffic did you get from Twitter specifically? Like, did the did a lot of leads evaporate?

Chris: [\(00:21:15\)](#) So there was a time if this had happened to us in 2019 or 2020, it would have killed the company Because there was a time where all of our growth came from people launching on Twitter. And I think he thought that that was still the case. Fortunately, Twitter's share of traffic had already been declining, and we've been building up some, like, network and discovery features. And so it wound up being the case that although it was very traumatic for a bunch of individual writers who had Twitter audiences who were kinda depending on it, if you looked at, like, our numbers overall, I don't think you'd be able to see where it happened. Oh, interesting.

It was it had been, like, kind of, like, a multiyear process of just Twitter becoming less and less important as a source of traffic to us. And so it was a big it was it was a big stressful thing. A lot of people ex our customers experience that as stressful, rightfully so, but it was not the existential threat to the business that I think you probably imagined that it was.

Jessica: [\(00:22:12\)](#) So sort of looking back in hindsight, was it worse doing this?

Chris: [\(00:22:16\)](#) Well, I think it was. And because and by the way, so we launched this, you know, this notes feed, right, that's got short form you know, it's got short form things that are kind of like tweets. You can actually link to long form articles. They're well integrated. You can share quotes nicely.

You can sort of leads you into long and interesting things. And it probably, like we probably spent two years where that thing, like, didn't work at all. There was kinda just, like, this core hardcore set of, like, a few of our most intense writers and Substackers were kind of like there was maybe, like, you know, a few thousand people using this quiet little corner of the app. It wasn't even the home screen of the app at the time. There was, like, a second page where it just had this weird little thing.

And I think if you were a professional manager, you would kill that thing. It's stupid. It's like it's not working. It it's actually in my view, having built a messaging app before this, it's a miracle it didn't totally die because the expectation is that it just it completely dies. And so the fact that it was, like, kinda there on life support was pretty I was like, this is great.

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And everybody even at the company was like, what are you talking about? This is great. Like, you got, like, a thousand people kind of, like, talking in this stupid second tab of the app. But we believed that it was an essential part of the thing we were trying to create. And so we just kept insisting that it had to work.

And we worked on it, and we worked on it, and we worked on it. And, eventually, we got it working.

Jessica: Justin Khan was just telling me over lunch that he really likes it. He he's really into it. Hey. [\(00:23:43\)](#) We made it. Yeah.

So if you had been sort of a nonfounder, you hadn't written that manifesto, this

Chris: Thing would be You wouldn't build in the first place. You wouldn't get in a pissing match with Elon even if it was one-sided. And I guess is that just getting pissed on? Maybe this is this analogy is not as That [\(00:23:58\)](#)

Jessica: May be what it is. Fact. [\(00:24:10\)](#)

Chris: And I don't think you would have kept it up. Right? Like, you if you're sort of if you're in the and it's very reasonable. This is a the it's in most cases, the right thing to do is, yeah, you try lots of stuff. If you start hitting a wall, it's not going easily. [\(00:24:13\)](#)

You give it up. You try something else. We do that all the time. But you have to be able to know the difference between things that you're, like, trying to figure out if they will work and things that you have decided that they must work and that you're willing to, like, apply yourself over a period of years to, like, figure out how to make them work. And I do think that there are there are great things that you can build that are only accessible in that second mode.

Jessica: I love that that thought. That's a good thing that I think everyone can learn from. Just so I have closure, are you still Voldemort on Twitter? [\(00:24:50\)](#)

Chris: No. I think you can say Substack now. [\(00:25:01\)](#)

Jessica: And you can link? I mean, I know links. [\(00:25:02\)](#)

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Chris: [\(00:25:04\)](#) They don't link. Are kinda dead across the board now, so we're sort of like we're in the same boat as everyone else, unfortunately. But you don't have to use Twitter anymore. You can open up the Substack app. Justin Khan will be there.

Jessica: [\(00:25:14\)](#) Right. Right. So just I we don't have ton tons more time, but who is the typical Substack user right now, and what are you in all different industries and things? What does a normal one look like?

Chris: [\(00:25:31\)](#) There's no such thing as a normal Substack user. I mean, I think of us as, an index fund of culture. And there really is there's, like, a staggering breadth of, like, what people write about and produce, but there is there is some common attributes. And I would say if you're a creator, a writer on Substack, it's somebody that can have a cult following. It's somebody where the intensity of how much people care about it and value it is high regardless of the size of the audience.

That's the place that Substack is uniquely valuable for and the type of person that uniquely values what we can bring. And then, you know, I think of the audiences are the people who are who are showing up for those things, who want something that's, like, deep and real and are interested in, you know, smart long form stuff.

Jessica: [\(00:26:14\)](#) I sort of feel like you're describing paulgraham.com. Yeah. But he

Chris: [\(00:26:20\)](#) He hates this idea. He still thinks it's not working.

Jessica: [\(00:26:28\)](#) I had to try. People are always trying to get him to get off the Yahoo, the old, via web Yahoo.

Chris: [\(00:26:35\)](#) We gotta get we gotta get this podcast on substackers.

Jessica: [\(00:26:37\)](#) Do. Us just very quickly. What do you offer for podcasters?

Chris: [\(00:26:41\)](#) So you can How would it work? You can publish your podcast on Substack just like you would any other podcast host. Goes everywhere. You can put it on Spotify. You can put it on the Apple podcast app, totally free.

The Social Radars

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When people they can sign up to it just like they would any other Substack, and you get their email address. Oh. You don't have to, but if you ever decided, hey. I actually wanna, like, write a note to all the people who subscribe to my podcast, you can, which is a nice benefit.

Jessica: [\(00:27:06\)](#) I would like that because we do seasons, and sometimes there's a couple months in between seasons. And it would be a nice way to reach people that actually care to say, hey. It's coming, you know, next month or whatever.

Chris: [\(00:27:17\)](#) Great. And all of the lovely people who use the Substack app will discover your nice you know, discover clips, discover episodes, be able to share and talk about it.

Jessica: [\(00:27:26\)](#) Awesome. That sounds great. Well, I think we better wrap up, but we'd love to have you come back sometime and do a real longer form episode with us.

Chris: [\(00:27:35\)](#) I love that.

Jessica: [\(00:27:36\)](#) I've I've loved hearing your story, and thank you for being so honest and sharing it with us.

Chris: [\(00:27:42\)](#) Thank you for having me.

Jessica: [\(00:27:42\)](#) Thanks, Chris. Thanks, Chris.